KETTLEPOT'S SHOP OF ODDITIES

THE MYSTERY SURROUNDING THE DISAPPEARANCE OF A LOCAL SHOPKEEPER

Treyos Kettlepot was a child when he stowed away on a ship owned by dwarven traders from Waterdeep. Once arriving in Chult, Kettlepot spent what remained of his childhood living as a street urchin in Crelt, a town lying along the southern coastline of the island. At the age of fifteen, Kettlepot had a chance meeting with Kralt Freel, a local mage and a collector of oddities from the numerous shipwrecks which dotted the beachfront and rocky bluffs of Wild Coast. Freel became a father to Treyos, teaching him the business and eventually helping Kettlepot to become a local proprietor himself. Until recently, Kettlepot witnessed a modest amount of success. He was locally known for providing a fair price in the purchase and trade of unique and magical artifacts. The week prior to the Festival of Thard, Kettlepot's shop remained closed. Because there was no explanation and no forewarning, customers assumed that the old human had taken the opportunity to visit friends from Mezro. Two weeks have past; residents of Crelt are becoming worried—many wonder what has happened. Where is he? And, what is to become of *Kettlepot's Shop of Oddities*?

This adventure is best played with a group of 2-4 characters of level 3-6.



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TABLE OF CONTENTS

Introduction 4

The Town of Crelt

Town NPCs 4
Krel Trowing 4
Sped the Street Urchin 4

Adventuring Context and the Story Hook

Random Event Table 6
Finding Kettlepot's Shop 6

Entering The Shop

The Shop 7
The Back Room 7
The Failed Teleportation Circle 9
Investigating the Death 10
Solving the Mystery 10
The Suspects 11
The Final Solution 12

Resources 13



Introduction

KETTLEPOT'S SHOP OF ODDITIES is an adventure for characters between a third and sixth level of play. The Dungeon Master (DM) may choose to connect this short module with the TOMB OF ANNIHILATION story arc; however, players from any location within the island continent of CHULT may travel to Crelt to solve the mysterious disappearance of Treyos Kettlepot.

The adventure is broken into three parts. Adventurers will visit the town of Crelt and take in its unique and magical qualities. Next, they will visit Kettlepot's shop to determine what may have happened to the old shopkeeper. Finally, and with the aid of a variety of clues and unnatural experiences, the characters will discover Treyos's fate and what evil stands behind his disappearance.

The Town of Crelt

Crelt does not appear in the lore of The Forgotten Realms. It was established in 1137 DR by a group of explorers and traders who wished to organize a safe haven and trade cooperative along the southern coast of the peninsula. In its early years, the town and its residents experienced a trade boom as large seaport communities like Waterdeep became aware of region's natural resources and the growing markets of its rural towns and cities. This economic boom reached its height in 1389 DR when a major trade guild in Waterdeep identified the coastal towns and harbor cities of Chult as their primary foreign market. As Waterdeep guilds grew and prospered, so did the demand for the expansion of its trade networks beyond the Sword Coast. At its height, Crelt was home to 2,800 residents, many traveling to the area from the Sword Coast and the Western Heartlands. Those arriving in this coastal community included militia members and mercenaries, academics and arcane researchers, and maritime traders. The town has continued to prosper; however, the competing factions and corrupt trade practices of communities to the north and west have spread to this island continent.

The DM may begin by reading the following:

> *You and your fellow adventurers have entered the bustling town of Crelt. As the sun rises over the edge of a nearby mountain range, shopkeepers, bankers, and street merchants open their businesses.*
>
> *Unlike your previous experiences in rural parts of the continent, the residents of this community hardly notice your group.*
>
> *The only attention that you receive comes from the numerous venders that recognize travelers with swollen coin purses and exotic weapons.*

The Dungeon Master (DM) may wish to allow his or her players to reflect on what brought them to this community—it may be as simple as needing rations and goods for their exploration of Chult. Or, it may be the rumors of Crelt's exotic wares and magical streets.

If the characters need more information about the town and the current dangers, read the following text:

> *As you take in the busy streets, you hear patrons whispering about a local shopkeeper who has not been seen for the last two weeks. Nearby venders scoff at the concern of their young patrons, remarking that "old Kettlepot is probably visiting his magic-user friends in Mezro… he'll be back."*
>
> *As your attention returns to the busy street, you hear a vender cry out. "Goods for sale! The finest dragon fruit in all of Chult! Don't pass up your chance. The fruit is going fast!"*

Town NPCs

Crelt is a diverse town. Being so close to the southern coastline of the continent, this community is not only filled with the many races of the area, but it includes traders, explorers, and academics from the Sword Coast. Some residents—many living in the southern part of the town—are emigres from as far north as Neverwinter.

The two important NPCs are (1) Kettlepot's longtime friend **Krel Trowing**, a dwarf from Port Nyanzaru, and (2) a human street urchin who goes by the name of **Sped**. Both are aware of Kettlepot's recent disappearance—they will seek the help of anyone who does not appear to be from Crelt. The DM may use Krel or Sped to move the story forward. Sped spends his days running through the market looking for wealthy travelers. He is known to be an avid pickpocket of foreign visitors. It will require a DC 17 to persuade Krel or Sped to join the party; however, if convinced, they will lead the travelers to any place they wish to go. Krel and Sped will emphasize the importance of visiting Kettlepot's shop.

The DM may choose to introduce Krel as the vender crying out for customers to purchase his dragon fruit (see the above-listed reading), or someone with a passive perception of 17 or less may be pickpocketed by Sped—he will get caught.

Krel Trowing (NPC)

Krel Trowing was born to Dwarven parents living under the Peaks of Flame. His early years were spent working alongside his father in local mines. It is in this environment that Krel learned two important lessons—life is filled with trials and tribulation, and if one is to make his life above ground, he must seek his wealth in honest trade. It is for these reasons that Trowing has not sought membership among any of the local guilds, choosing instead to seek his fortune as an entrepreneur.

Krel is not much of a fighter; however, he is master of making and closing "the deal." He imports fruit and fine metalwork from Calimshan in West Faerûn. His contracts require him to coordinate overland transports from harbor towns in the north.

Krel Trowing

medium humanoid (human), neutral good

Armor Class 13 (leather armor)
Hit Points 16 (3d8 + 3)
Speed 25 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
11 (+0)	14 (+2)	12 (+1)	14 (+2)	13 (+1)	15 (+2)

Skills nature +4, perception +5, persuasion +4, insight +4, stealth +3, and survival +5
Senses passive perception 15.
Languages Common, Goblin, Dwarvish, and Elvish
Challenge 1/2 (100 XP)

Appraisal. Krel understands the value of goods and their material source(s). His appraisal skill is set at a +3 bonus.

Actions

Dagger. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +3 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target at a time. *Hit:* 3 (1d4 +2) piercing damage. *Ranged Weapon Attack:* +2 to hit, ranged 20/60 ft., one creature. *Hit:* 4 (1d4 + 2) piercing damage.

Sped the Street Urchin

Small humanoid (human), chaotic neutral

Armor Class 8 (no armor, only torn street clothes)
Hit Points (1d8)
Speed 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
8 (-1)	18 (+4)	10 (+0)	7 (-1)	13 (+1)	11 (+0)

Skills nature +3, perception +3

Senses passive perception 14.
Languages Common, Druidic, and Dwarvish
Challenge 0 (10 XP)

Quickstep. Sped has advantage on attack rolls and skill checks if he is in a crowded setting.

Chance. Sped has an advantage in any game of chance or any situate where players are gambling or betting.

Actions

Small Metal Rod. (Often hidden on his person.) *Melee Weapon Attack*: +2 to hit, reach 5ft., one target. *Hit*: 3 (1d6) bludgeoning damage, 4 (1d8) bludgeoning damage if wielded with two hands, or 6 (1d8 +2) bludgeoning damage if the target is surprised or in a crowded space.

Bite or Scratch. +1 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target at a time. *Bite:* 2 (1d4 +0) piercing damage. *Scratch*: 3 (1d4 +1), injury poison if scratched (DC 13, constitution save), 10 (3d6), 3 (1d6) on a failed save. Seek medical treatment immediately or 3 (1d6) damage is taken every hour the wound is exposed or untreated.

Sped the Street Urchin (NPC)

Sped is an annoying scrap. His origins are unknown; however, his ability with slight-of-hand and his knowledge of gambling lead many to believe that he was trained by Crelt's thieves guild—a group of local fire knives who call themselves "The Underlings."

If asked, Sped will deny his wrongdoing, choosing to describe himself as a **"right-young lad, seeking fame and fortune in Chult's most beautiful town!"**

As the story unfolds, the adventurers will realize that Sped has a soft place in his heart for Kettlepot. Many of the merchants who had shops near Treyos's establishment, would describe the little thief as Kettlepot's personal project.

"He loved that filthy little thief—I don't think Sped would steal from Treyos if his life depended on it."

In fact, many believe that Kettlepot was getting ready to retire, and as a one-time street urchin himself, Kettlepot had a soft place in his heart for Sped. It is commonly understood that Sped would be Kettlepot's heir—he stands to inherit Treyos's shop and all of its magical goods.

Adventuring Context and the Story Hook

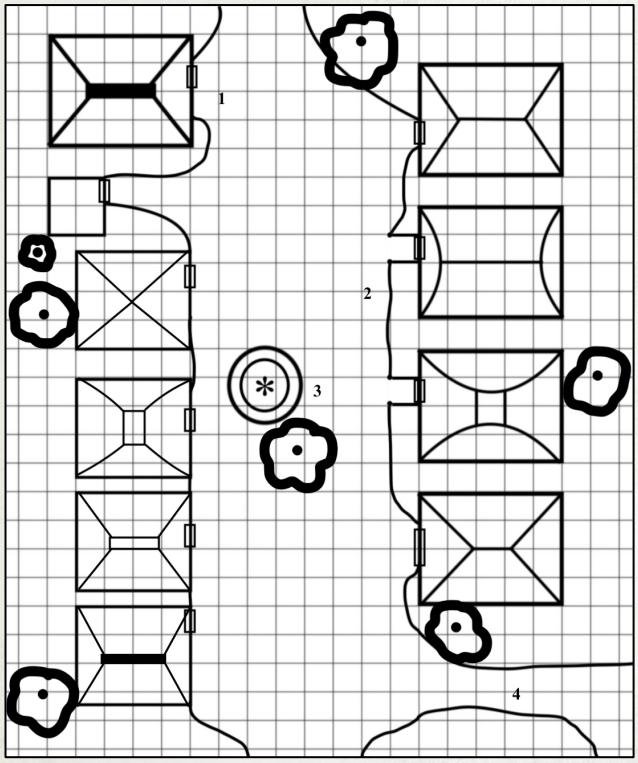
When the adventurers arrive in Crelt they will be presented with men, women, and children running from shop to shop gathering food and goods for daily living. Most patrons will be too busy to talk, but the vendors will always be willing to answer a question or sell their wares to foreign travelers.

If the adventurers attempt to stop and interrogate a resident of the town (DC 13 to strike up a conversation) they will quickly find out that even though Crelt is a tightly knit community, the design and layout of its neighborhoods result in the sharing of very little personal information. Patrons will direct questions to local shopkeepers and street vendors if asked about Kettlepot.

Random Event Table – Market Street

Use this table (and Map 1) to provide your players with a feel for what is happening in the town.

d12	Encounter
1-4	A fight breaks out in the middle of the street. One of the brawlers flashes a dagger that is encrusted with the symbol of the Zhentarim faction.
5-7	A commotion begins at a nearby corner as two barbarians return from the jungle with what appears to be an undead human (MM p. 315-316). The creature is being dragged through the streets in a bamboo cage.
8-9	An odd trail of smoke is appearing from the rooftop of one of the nearby shops (Map 2). With closer inspection, the adventurers find that this is Kettlepot's shop. Please note, if this is the result of the random event roll, the players will officially begin the campaign—see next section.
10-12	Sped breaks away from the group and is seen pickpocketing a wealthy trader. The trader's clothing reminds characters of Waterdeep's Jeweler's Guild (the DM may choose to use a history check—DC 15—to reveal this information).



Map 1. A depiction of the village square. #1 is the hall of a local trade guild, #2 is a row of merchants' shops (varying goods), #3 is a fountain feature that is the center of the open-air market, and #4 is the path to Kettlepot's store. (1 grid square = 5 square feet)

Finding Kettlepot's Shop

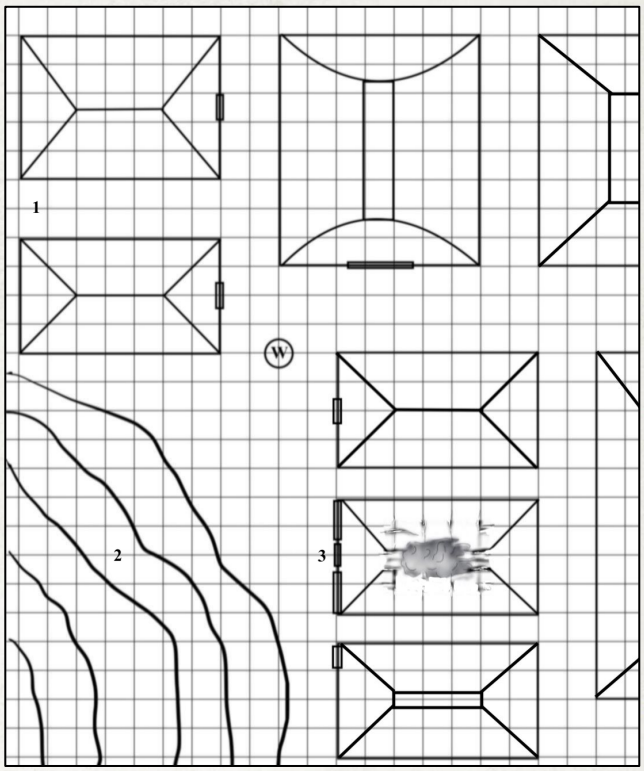
Sped or Krel will lead the adventurer's to Kettlepot's shop. Either NPC will eventually point out the locked shop. Once found, read the below-listed description.

Kettlepot's shop stands out from the other shops on the street. The façade consists of a single, heavy, wooden front door flanked by two large stain glass windows. The windows are ten feet across and nine feet tall, they, and the carved wood beams that frame the doorway make up the entire storefront.

A pipe shop and a furrier flank Kettlepot's shop. Neither are as ornate.

The door to the shop is arched and ornately carved. It is covered with depictions of ships at sea and dragon-like sea creatures rising out of the surf. At eye level the door reads "Kettlepot's Shop of Oddities."

Nailed to the door is a hand-written note.



Map 2. The area around Kettlepot's Shop (#3); #1 is the entry point to the area, #2 is a small body of water, "W" is a public well.

The sign states "CLOSED FOR THE HOLIDAY." If present, Sped's inability to read will eventually remove him from the list of potential suspects involved in Kettlepot's disappearance. If Krel leads the adventurers to the shop, he will read the sign and remark that it is only written in common. He may remain a suspect if present during the investigation of the shop.

A trail of smoke is visible from the rooftop of Kettlepot's shop. The smoke is white and does not appear to be the result of a large fire. In fact, players with a **passive perception** score of **12 or higher** will surmise that this smoke is from a source that is nearly extinguished—whatever is associated with the smoke is smoldering.

Once the note is found, the party will hear a breathing noise (like a sniffing dog) coming from the bottom of the door. As they take note of this sound, the breathing will stop and a low growl will be heard. An insight or perception (wisdom) check (**DC 13**) will reveal that this is a dog. If Krel or Sped is present, either NPC will mention that Kettlepot had a dog (Gary) who was only trusting of people that he knows—especially those who had the foresight to provide him with a treat. **(This is the first of several clues that will help solve the mystery of the disappearance.)**

ENTERING THE SHOP

The ornate door is locked. A set of thief's tools (DC 10) may be used to unlock the door. (The door can be physically forced open with a strength check—DC 17.) Once the door is breached, players will notice that the shop is dark. Prior to gaining entry to the shop, players may wish to gain insight into the condition of the shop by attempting to look through the stain glass panels. These panels are opaque—little, if any, information will be gained from studying the windows. (If a player attempts to remove a pane of glass, only a dark front room will be visible. There will be an odor of burned parchment that will be noticeable.)

At this point in the adventure, the DM should provide players with clue cards, or challenge the players to begin to take notes and map their surroundings. The DM will NOT provide a map or written clues for the adventurers.

Upon opening the door, the players will notice an odor of burning or burned parchment. Also, as ambient light from the street enters the doorway will players notice a dog staring back at them—he will appear out of breath and hostile. The DM will read the below-listed description.

As light cascades into the open doorway, you are immediately struck by two things. First, there is an odor of burnt parchment. Although it is not strong, it does appear that the source of this smell may be the cause of the trail of smoke that is visible from outside. Additionally, there is a dog approximately three feet inside the archway of the door that is staring back at you. He is a small sized hound who is grimacing—you hear a low growl.

(If an above-listed NPC is still present, read the below-listed dialogue.)

"Oh, don't mind him. That is Gary, Kettlepot's mangy mutt. Give'em a bit of your rations and he will consider you a friend, or at least he will tolerate you. Old Gary only tolerates people that give him a treat—or, people he has met before—otherwise he will pester them with snarls and won't stop barking."

THE SHOP

The front room of the shop shows signs of heavy foot traffic. It contains a sales counter and chairs. The walls of the store are covered in shelves. Each shelf has bottles and objects that seem exotic in nature, many show evidence of exposure to saltwater. The room is twenty feet across and is twenty feet deep. The room is dark; however, the adventurers will note that light would have been provided by crude oil lamps and the stain glass windows of the front facade. Unlit lamps line the walls, they are situated just above each shelving unit.

The contents of the room seem well organized. Objects are categorized and shelved by effect; each shelving unit is marked in common and dwarvish. The markings across the stone walls of the shop include the follow descriptions: **illusions, healers, star charts and lenses, spell books, folklore, cultural artifacts, insects and birds, ship logs, weeds and herbs, fire starters, and bones and mummy dust.** The below-listed chart will help to randomize a player's study of each shelving unit. Each shelf will contain up to eight objects. The listed effect associated with objects will be connected to the area studied. These areas coincide to the descriptions listed above. The DM should study these categories prior to game play and limit the amount of investigation made by party members. This portion of the adventure is not meant to be a chance to find and steal magical items.

1d100	Effect	Material	Condition
1-20	Magical – one charge	Exotic	Needs repair
21-30	Magical – rechargeable daily	Common	Functioning
31-45	Magical – recharged with elf blood	Regional	Functioning
46-60	Magical – recharged with human blood	Foreign	Broken
61-75	Non-magical	Historic-regional	Legible
76-80	Non-magical	Historic-foreign	Illegible
81-90	Non-magical	Prehistoric-regional	Understandable
91-100	Ancient-outside of the realms	Prehistoric-foreign	Requires study (1d10 days; DC 15 history)

Most items will have a mild magical effect, or they are antiques with little to no value. Values may be estimated by using the equipment

section of the PHB (pages 148-154). Any objects taken from the shop that are not paid for will be considered stolen by NPCs and the local magistrate. NPCs will suggest that adventurers leave money next to Kettlepot's coin box if they are interested in making a purchase. If an NPC considers an object a clue to Kettlepot's disappearance, he will suggest that the object is kept—payment is unnecessary when it comes to solving the mystery.

Illusion:

Potions of illusion will NOT be rechargeable. These may be poured out onto a surface for the desired effect. All effects will follow the minor illusion effect description in the player's handbook (PHB, page 260).

Any objects associated with illusions (i.e. minor illusion effect) will be rechargeable if they are identified as functional. Objects will be common to their point of origin (e.g. Chult = tropical, Neverwinter and surrounding landscape = cool dry climate, etc.)

Healers:

All healing potions and lotions discovered (if functioning and usable) will provide 1d8 points of healing. These will NOT be rechargeable.

If the healing resource is an object it may be recharged; however, the healing effect will be reduced to 1d4 points.

Star Charts and Lenses:

These objects will be maritime in origin. If a star chart is found to be magical, it will require the user to have an intelligence score of 14 or higher. The magic will allow for navigation by moonlight and visible star constellations. If it works it may be rechargeable. If broken, it will be described as torn and useless. Regional star charts will be assigned to a region in the forgotten realms.

Lenses will be telescopic in design. If functional, they may be fashioned into a telescope or binoculars. These devices will improve sight up to one mile in linear distance.

If any of these objects are prehistoric, they must be described as composed of natural materials. Their use will also require a wisdom score of 15 or higher.

Spell Books:

All eight of these books contain the writings of wizards. They describe arcane experiments and related ingredients. Nothing new may be learned from these texts—many of which seem illegible.

One of the spell books is enchanted. When picked-up it will immediately begin to fly around the room. This will cause the dog to begin barking. The book cannot be tamed or controlled. The book is under the control of a command spell (PHB, page 223). Once activated the book will fly about for one minute. Players will not be able to determine the source of this spell or the reason for its casting.

Folklore:

All of these objects will be made from natural materials found throughout the realms. They will require an intelligence score of 12 or higher to use. If these objects are usable, they will provide a player with an advantage on related history checks.

Cultural Artifacts:

These objects will appear useless to adventurers, especially those seeking an advantage in travel and anthropological/archaeological field work. All cultural objects will be associated with Chult and will have a value of 12 to 30 silver pieces. Keeping these objects may help in later adventuring. They include: a mummified hand, a polished stone, a bone awl, a carving (humanoid shape), a spear point, a circular piece of wood with geometric shapes carved into the center of each side, a large shark tooth, and a fragment of what appears to be a meteorite.

If any of these objects are found to be magical they will perform Druidcraft (PHB, 236; transmutation cantrip). Players wielding these objects must be able to perform a druid cantrip.

Insects and Birds:

These are taxidermal. They are drawn from the southern coastline of Chult. Many of the birds will include props associated with their individual ecosystem.

If any of these are found to be magical, they will perform Calm Emotions (PHB, page 221; 2nd level enchantment). Players wielding these objects must be capable of performing a 2nd level spell.

Ship Logs:

All of these scrolls are written in common and contain the day-to-day activities on the numerous ships that have wrecked along the southern coastline of Chult. (None of these scrolls are prehistoric. Only historic or modern in nature.)

If any of these are found to be magical, they will perform Find the Path (PHB, page 240; 6th level divination). Players wielding these objects must be capable of performing a 6th level divination spell.

Weeds and Herbs:

This dried plant material was gathered locally.

If any of these objects are found to be magical they will serve as components for spells. These may substitute for missing components. Prehistoric weeds and herbs will be partially fossilized.

Fire Starters:

These items include uniquely carved tinderbox sets, decorative fire pouches for hot coals, and ember and ash separators. Those that are found to be magical are enchanted with the conjuration cantrip Produce Flame (see PHB, page 269).

Bones and Mummy Dust:

Most of these materials appear to be taken from graves. They are dry and many appear to be in a serious state of decay. Those objects that are found to be magical will be drawing upon the weave that was retained and used by the original owner. This individual was, most often, the source of the body part. Enchanted items will carry with them the spell Detect Evil and Good (PHB, page 231).

The Back Room

There is a door situated at the center of the back wall to the front room. It is closed. Shelving units flank either side. Once the adventurers enter the front room of the shop and look around, they will easily determine that the burnt smell is coming from whatever is behind the door (DC 5)—i.e. the back room. Those players who are looking around the shop will also note that there is neither a bed nor a water bowl for the dog. Once this is noted, the DM may read the following description:

As you look around the shop, you notice a door in the center of the back wall , it stands twenty feet from the entrance—shelves of oddities flank either side. It appears to be closed.

The source of the burnt parchment odor is coming from behind this door. You also notice that Gary has no place to lie down in the shop, his food and water are not present.

Gary is sniffing around the base of this door. He is whimpering.

The door is not locked. If the adventurers decide to open the door read the following description:

As you open the door, Gary becomes unsettled. He pushes past you and runs into the room.

Natural light cascades down into the center of the room. Scraps of paper and burnt parchment are falling from above. Outside air circulates down from a large hole in the ceiling. The hole appears to have been made by some sort of explosion that was centered below the opening. The fragments of timber that are visible along the edges of the opening contain burning embers that are slowly extinguishing.

The room appears to have been Kettlepot's study. It contained a small loft. The loft contains bookshelves and part of a bed. The lower level is similar, it contains bookshelves and storage cabinets, the contents of which have been overturned by the explosion.

There appears to be a person of short stature lying face down in the center of the room. He is not moving and is surrounded by a series of geometric symbols. Outside of these symbols, the floor appears to be scorched by flame.

Gary is sniffing around the body. He seems unsettled.

If an NPC has accompanied the party, he will immediately recognize the dog's familiarity with the body—he will conclude that it is Kettlepot. If the remains are inspected, the party will immediately learn that it is Kettlepot—he is dead. A medicine or investigation check (DC 6) will reveal that the body has burn marks on its palms and face. Kettlepot's clothing is also scorched. The DM may roll a 1d20 at any time in order to reveal what the characters see as they investigate the body. (The DM may reveal some or all of the observations itemized in the table listed below.)

1d20	Random Observations
1-4	Gary appears to be growling at an individual lying below what remains of Kettlepot's loft and the roof of the building.
5-12	You notice the outline of a small individual crouching along the west side of the room. He is leaning against the lower level of the bookshelves that surround the room. This may have protected him from the blast.
13-15	A human is laying along the eastern edge of the room. He is face down and appears to be unconscious.
16-20	A symbol along the north edge of the ritual circle faintly glows. This geometric symbol looks like a map of the solar system with a triangle connecting three planetary bodies. The sun lies at the center of the triangle.



The Failed Teleportation Circle

Any character in the party who possesses magical training will immediately recognize the geometric symbols that make up the circle around Kettlepot's body. The symbols are drawn from the glyphs of Realmspace (a symbolic depiction of the Torilian solar system).

A successful wisdom check (DC 15) will reveal that Kettlepot and his companions were attempting to magically enter or teleport to one of the portals of the quasi-elemental plane of Radiance. (It should be noted that there are no true stars in Realmspace, only the sun that is situated near the center of the crystal sphere. What appears to be stars are, in fact, planar portals.) Upon realizing this, magic users will acknowledge that this was a futile plan—anyone or anything attempting to enter the plane of Radiance would be destroyed. (Hence the explosion.) A spelljammer ship would be the preferred method of travel; however, it should be noted that the ship would not have been able to enter the plane of Radiance. (If Kettlepot and his friends would have been able to acquire a ship, they would only have been able to move out of Realmspace through

a portion of the Phlogiston. This would not allow them to achieve their goal of traveling into Radiance.)

The DM may read the following account in order to inform the characters of what Kettlepot and his associates were attempting. It will also provide a premise for Kettlepot's injuries.

> The circle of symbols that surround Kettlepot's body appears to be a mechanism for planar travel. Clearly Kettlepot did not understand the nature of this process.
>
> You sense that magical forces remain in this place.
>
> Gary is unsettled and you notice movement throughout the room; at least two people are recovering from whatever happened in the study.



Investigating the Death

The three characters listed below are the suspects. **Gary seems familiar with two of them**. The DM should not reveal any of their alignments. He or she may, however, choose to describe the characters and their level of understanding as it relates to magic (this is dependent upon the questions adventurers are asking).

Upon investigating the body, the players learn that Kettlepot was **poisoned**—with an investigation check (DC 13) they will also realize that the poison, not the explosion, was the cause of his death. A small drop of blood is visible on his right forearm; additionally, the corpse smells like burnt toast. The poison used causes cardiac arrest within seven minutes from the time that it enters the bloodstream. Once metabolized by the body, the poison causes the skin of the victim to give off this burnt odor—a perfect cover. **The murderer knew that the teleportation circle would fail, he poisoned Kettlepot with a janus thorn (Nature check; DC 10)**. The janus plant is native to the interior to Chult. At the time that the poison was being administered, Kettlepot would have thought that he was bitten by a small bug. This would not have stopped the ceremony.

During the ceremony, the participants would have utilized a spell book to conjure the planar space, those involved in the rite would have become dizzy during the ritual.

When the explosion occurred, Kettlepot appears to have stumbled back and to the right, then he collapsed forward in the center of the circle. The explosion was felt only by those along the circle's edge.

The spell book (i.e. the Book of Light) lies along the northeastern edge of the circle. It is closed and is situated a few inches from Kettlepot's right hand. The book is enchanted, **the killer searched for this magical tome and knows its true power**. He also knows that the enchantment must be undone if the tome is to be of any use to him.

Solving the Mystery

Clues and conclusions are listed below.

(1) Light before and during the ceremony was very low—it was almost pitch black—**only those suspects with infravision or darkvision would be able to see Kettlepot well enough to administer the poison—in this case, a needle or thorn**. (This clue does not identify the murderer outright, but it does reduce the field.) The murderer still hast he thorn, it is no longer poisonous.

Conclusion #1: the murderer is not the druid.

(2) Kettlepot's dog (Gary) barks at anyone he doesn't know. The adventurers were accosted by this dog until he was given rations or kind attention. Of the three remaining suspects, the dog was witnessed to be hostile only to the dwarf, **meaning the dwarf was unfamiliar to the dog**. The perpetrator was a person who had visited the shop a number of times—he or she would have been familiar to the dog.

Conclusion #2: the murderer is not the hill dwarf.

(3) Of the remaining suspects, the perpetrator was the one who was aware that the book of mystery was an enchanted/living book. He (**the elf wizard**) does not react when, and if, the book is discovered to be enchanted (example: it flies about the room once the adventurers interact with the document; the elf does not react).

The wizard wanted the book for himself; however, he needed time to break the enchantment. Doing away with Kettlepot and the three other ritual participants would allow him the opportunity to take the book from the shop. Unfortunately, he was unaware of its true power and all oft he dangers involved in the rite or he did not think that the explosion would have been violent.

Conclusion #3: the murderer is the high elf wizard.

Suspects

Flint Fowling (Cleric)

medium humanoid (hill dwarf), male, neutral good

Armor Class 18 (chain mail , shield)
Hit Points 35 (3d8 + 3)
Speed 25 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
14 (+2)	8 (-1)	15 (+2)	10 (+0)	18 (+4)	12 (+1)

Skills Insight +6, Religion +2, and Medicine +6
Senses darkvision (60 ft.); passive perception 14.
Languages Common, Goblin, Dwarvish, and Giant
Challenge 1/2 (100 XP)

Actions

Warhammer. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target at a time. *Hit:* 4 (1d6 +2) bludgeoning damage.

Cleric Abilities. Preserve Life (channel divinity) and Turn Undead (channel divinity).

Spellcasting. Wisdom is your spellcasting ability (DC 14; +6 to hit with spell attacks.

Cantrips: mending and thaumaturgy.

1st Level Spells: bless, cure wounds, and detect evil and good.

2nd Level Spells: calm emotions and prayer of healing.



Ras Mearl (Druid)

medium humanoid (human), male, lawful evil

Armor Class 13 (leather armor)
Hit Points 18 (3d8 + 3)
Speed 25 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
11 (+0)	14 (+2)	12 (+1)	14 (+2)	13 (+1)	15 (+2)

Skills nature +4, perception +5, persuasion +4, insight +4, stealth +3, and survival +5
Senses passive perception 15.
Languages Common, Goblin, Dwarvish, and Elvish

Spellcasting. Ras is a fourth level spellcaster. His spellcasting ability is Wisdom (spell save DC11. +3 to hit with a spell attack).

Cantrips: produce flame and shillelagh.

1st level spells: thunderwave, entangle, and speak with animals.

2nd level spells: barkskin, animal messenger.

Actions

Quarterstaff. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +2 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target at a time. *Hit:* 3 (1d6) bludgeoning damage, 1d8 if using two hands, 1d8+2 if wielded when casting shillelagh.

Druidic Book of Planes: This text may be connected to an elemental spell in Magic The Gathering universe (example: hydrolash). It may also be used to summon a creature from the same universe (example: the Ringward Owl). These phenomena may be used in a manner similar to a cantrip. In the case of a spell or skill, the action must first be prepared. After its use, it takes one round of action to recharge. A summoned creature will for thirty minutes. It may not be summoned again until a day has passed.



Reef Shreen (High Elf Wizard)

medium humanoid (elf), male, chaotic

Armor Class 13 or 16 (with mage armor)
Hit Points 31 (Hit Dice: 6d6)
Speed 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
10 (0)	16 (+3)	12 (+1)	18 (+4)	13 (+1)	8 (-1)

Skills Arcana +7, History +7, Investigation +7, Perception +4, Persuasion +2
Senses darkvision (60 ft.); passive perception 14.
Languages Common, Dwarvish, Elvish, and Giant
Challenge 1/2 (100 XP)

Actions

Dagger. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +3 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target at a time. *Hit:* 4 (1d6) piercing damage.

Spellcasting. Intelligence is your spellcasting ability (DC 14; +6 to hit with spell attacks.)

Cantrips (available at all times): fire bolt, ray of frost, and shocking grip.

Prepared Spells at the Time of the Interaction with the Adventurers:

1st Level Spells: detect magic, identify, mage armor, magic missile.

2nd Level Spells: flaming sphere, misty step, web.

3rd Level Spells: dispel magic, fireball, fly, and lightning bolt.

Equipment

Spell book (personal), two potions of healing (1d8 +spellcaster level of healing), backpack, 3 days of rations, rope, mirror, waterskin (full).

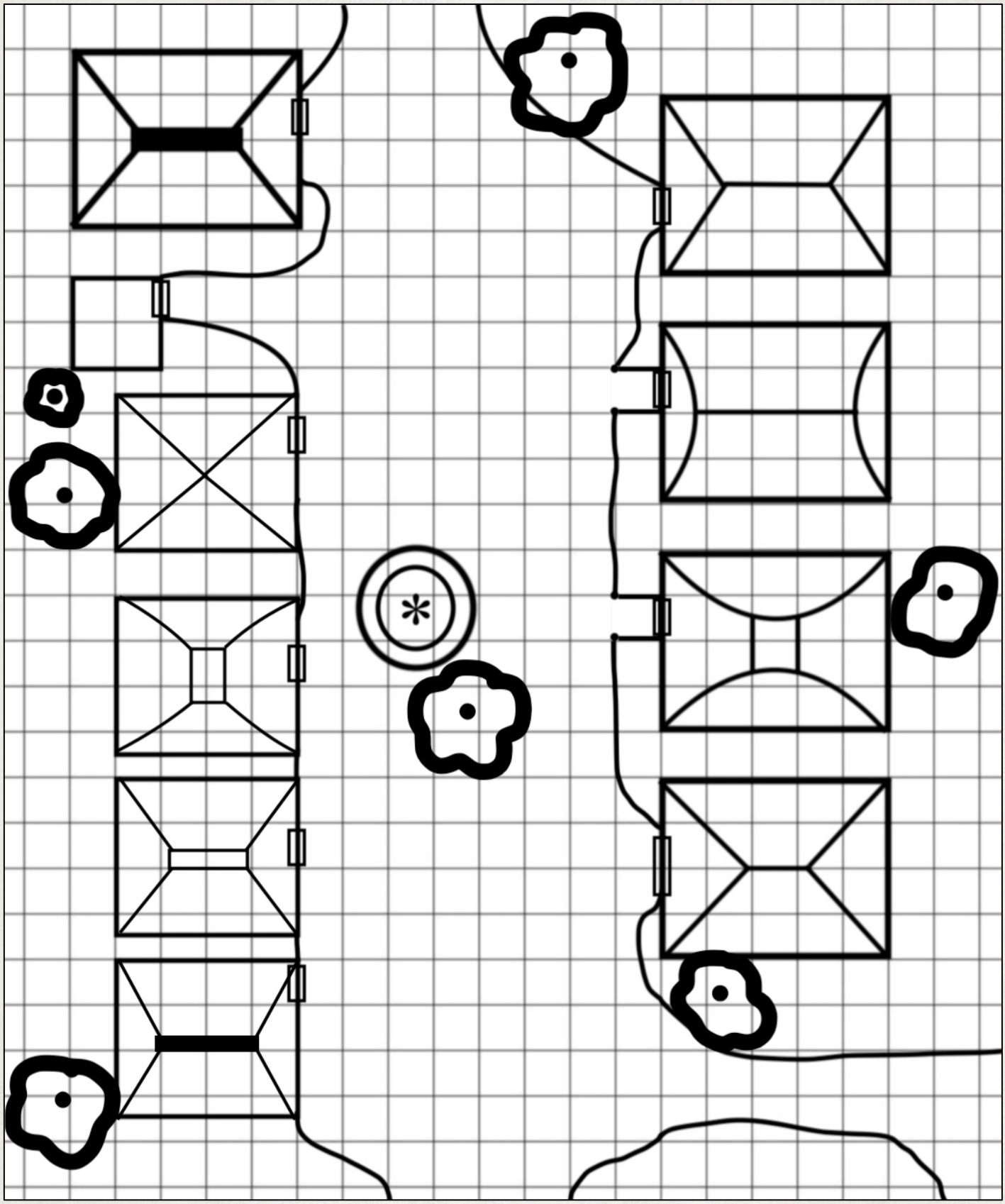
Valuables

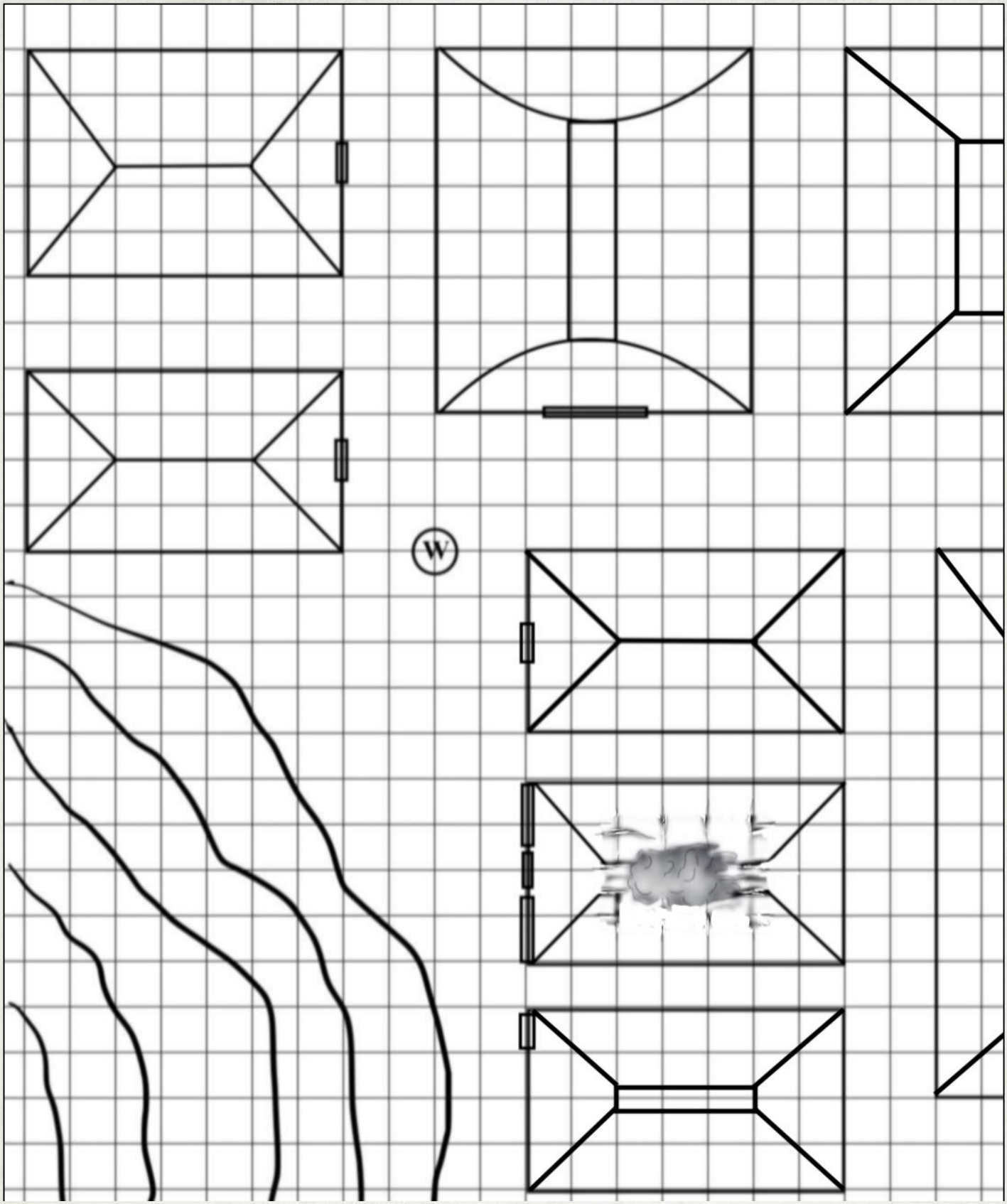
100 gps worth of gold dust, 2 pearls worth 100 gps each, and 120 silver pieces.

The Final Solution

Once the party has identified the murderer, they must decide what they should do with him. Reef will not release himself willingly into the custody of the local constable. It may result in a fight to the death, or Reef may attempt to escape.

If Reef is killed or captured, any nearby NPCs will suggest that the shop be permanently closed and that its contents be turned over to the local authorities. The adventurers may choose to take this advice, or they may choose to take goods and monies with them, including the Book of Light (this magical item may be studied and fashioned into an object that results in a teleportation event or spell, recharged daily with direct sunlight). Only a qualified magic user with an intelligence score of 16 or higher may disenchant and recharge the book. The DM may choose the appropriate spell to assign to the text, and the amount of time required to transform the nature of the book.




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